LAST UPDATED September 11, 2025

# Brave Browser Privacy Policy

**Our company does not store any record of people's browsing history. We don't write any personal data to the blockchain. The only way a user's data is stored by Brave is if the user has switched on Rewards or Sync.**

Read this document to understand how the Brave Browser and Brave's services use data.

## Other Brave Privacy Notices

- Brave Search Privacy Notice
- Brave Websites, Forums, and Email Privacy Notice
- Brave Rewards Advertiser Privacy Notice
- Brave Publishers and Creators Privacy Notice
- How to Exercise Your Right to Be Forgotten (RTBF) in Brave Search

In this notice "we", "us", etc. refers to Brave Software Inc, while "Brave" refers to the browser.

# Security & updates

Brave automatically checks for updates. This ensures that you always have access to the latest security fixes. We count the number and type of these requests when we receive them to produce aggregate statistics. No particular person's information can be identified in the statistics we produce.

You can also update to the latest version here.

## Safe Browsing

The Brave Browser automatically uses Google Safe Browsing to help protect you against websites, downloads and extensions that are known to be unsafe (such as sites that are fraudulent or that host malware). This service relies on storing URL hashes locally on your device. When a potentially unsafe site is visited, Google receives a partial URL hash of the site. This is necessary in order for Safe Browsing to work. The actual website address is never shared with the service provider.

On desktop, we proxy this service in order to prevent your IP address from being shared with Google.

On Android, we rely on the Safe Browsing functionality built into the operating system. Any requests to Google servers made by this component (by the Brave app or by another app) will expose your device IP address to Google.

On iOS, we use the Safe Browsing functionality provided by Safari. This functionality uses Google and Tencent Safe Browsing services depending on your region. Apple proxies requests to these services, exposing your device IP address to Apple.

Learn how to change your Safe Browsing settings.

# Sync

If you switch on Sync then your bookmarks, passwords and other data will be saved in an encrypted file on a cloud storage service, to which you will have the only decryption key.

The data[1] are entirely inaccessible to Brave and to the cloud storage provider. Learn how to switch on Sync here.

Unused Sync chains expire after 12 months and the associated server data may be permanently deleted after that time.

# Location

If you use Brave to visit a website that tracks user location, you may be asked whether you want the website to know where you are located. If you grant permission, the website will be sent an approximation of where you are located based on your IP address and information your operating system may provide, for example, the names of nearby WiFi access points. The website may store your location. Your location is not sent to us in this process.

See data processing details.

# Brave Rewards

If you enable Brave Rewards, we assign your Brave browser a "Rewards Payment ID", which is used to account for Basic Attention Token (BAT) rewards you may earn for seeing Brave Private Ads. We will also ask you to select your country, which we will use to assign a country code to your Rewards Payment ID. The country code helps us ensure Ads are displayed to individuals depending on their country. We will also use the country code to help us prevent fraud. You can find your Rewards Payment ID by navigating to brave://rewards-internals.

Even with Brave Rewards enabled and a Rewards Payment ID assigned, we never collect your browsing history or similar information, and we can't derive this information from your contributions to content creators or sites. We also cannot tell which specific Brave Private Ads you've seen or interacted with.

Note that we record the identifiers mentioned herein on servers located in the United States. We take a range of technical and organisational measures to safeguard personal data.

## Connecting a custodial account

When you choose to connect a custodial account to Brave Rewards using one of our custodial partners such as Uphold, Gemini, bitFlyer (Japan only), or ZebPay (India only), three things become associated with your Rewards Payment ID: a custodian ID, deposit address(es), and a country code. All three are assigned by the custodial partner. The deposit address allows us to make deposits to your custodial account, while the country code helps us prevent fraud and limit service to users in countries where Brave Rewards is supported. In addition, we also use IP addresses and Rewards Payment IDs associated with monthly BAT payments to safeguard against fraud. See the Brave Rewards data processing table

When you make an on-demand contribution to Brave Creators using BAT from your linked custodial account(s), the custodian can see and record the details of your contribution transactions (such as, but not limited to, the amount and the recipient). This is subject to the privacy policies of Uphold, Gemini, bitFlyer, or ZebPay. However, when using the Auto-Contribute feature to support Brave creators with BAT from your custodial account, neither Brave nor your custodian can tell which specific creators you're contributing to.

## Connecting a self-custody account

When you choose to connect a self-custody account/address (such as a Solana address), your Rewards Payment ID will be associated with your self-custody address. See the Brave Rewards data processing table for details of what data we process and why and for how long.

*Cookies*: As part of the process to connect your Solana address to your Rewards Payment ID, a temporary, security-related cookie will be set in your browser for one of our Rewards-related service domains. The purpose of this cookie is to protect you against cross-site forgery attacks during the connection process. The moment the cookie is done playing its role in the connection process, the cookie is immediately cleared from your browser.

# Ads

If you switch on Brave Rewards we automatically enable Brave Ads. This means you will receive ads in the form of notifications and in-browser sponsored content, and Basic Attention Tokens to reward you for viewing those ads. While the categories of ads that you see and when you see them are inferred from your browsing activity, the data are stored on your device and are inaccessible to us. We will receive anonymized confirmations for ads that you have viewed, but no data that identifies you or that can be linked to you as an individual leaves the Brave browser on your device. You can disable Ads by visiting `Settings > Brave Rewards > Ads` and turning off the Ads default.

Get Brave

users encounter as they browse the web) we use proven privacy mechanisms like local differential privacy that guarantee that no information about individual users will ever be revealed to us. Read more about how we achieve this with Privacy Preserving Product Analytics and Private Advertising Analytics. To read more about Brave Ads and privacy have a look at our FAQ.

Brave conducts A/B testing to support research into user engagement with Brave Ads to inform our strategy for choosing and displaying Ads to end-users. We use variables such as type of Ad, placement and timing. This is done in a way that protects end-user privacy - we cannot link data to individuals or their devices and nor can we identify users or their devices from the research.

# Brave Wallet

The Brave Wallet is a secure crypto wallet built directly into the Brave browser. You can buy, send, store, and swap thousands of assets (and NFTs) seamlessly on 100+ blockchain networks including Ethereum, Solana, Filecoin, and more. You can learn more about 'crypto wallets' and the Brave Wallet here

Brave Wallet relies on third party service providers to help us read and write transactional data from various blockchains including Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, and others on a users behalf. To do this we typically need to pass wallet address(s) or transactional data to these service providers in order to help users interact with the blockchain. In certain circumstances, such as when a service is used by default, Brave will proxy the requests to prevent data from being connected to your IP address and does not log this. By enabling

Brave Wallet, you consent to relying on these services to interact with the Blockchain when necessary.

Brave does not track any of the actions you make in your wallet. We strive to put privacy first:

- Brave proxies and strips the IP address associated with access to the Brave Wallet.
- When you make a transaction using a third party that redirects you to their services, such as an on-ramp partner, they will capture your IP address and may conduct identity verification checks in order to meet obligations they have under sanctions and anti-money laundering laws. You should review the privacy notices and terms of service of those third parties.
- We use Decentralised Exchange Aggregators (DEX) such as 0x for swaps made on EVM compatible blockchains and Jupiter for swaps completed on the Solana blockchain. They will also process your wallet address, related transaction data and your IP address but will ONLY use this data to fulfill the transaction (including getting a quote).
- We will use anonymized and aggregated statistics from on-ramp partners that include regional volumes of transactions, including daily number of transactions by token/chain; daily $ volume of transactions by token/chain; monthly unique transactions by token/chain. We use this statistical data to understand at a high level which cryptocurrency assets are being used and on which platforms.

# Sanctions Compliance

Cryptocurrency addresses that are listed on or otherwise associated with the Specially Designated Nationals and Blocked Persons List (SDN list) are ineligible to participate in any of Brave's services. Accordingly, Brave compares cryptographic addresses to the SDN list.

The Brave Wallet will not allow transfers to any sanctioned address – it has a built-in copy of the SDN list and does not contact any server to make this determination. We strive to put privacy first:

- Brave does not track any of the actions that you make in your wallet.
- Brave proxies and strips the IP address associated with access to the Brave Wallet.

- When you make a transaction using a third party that redirects you to their services, such as an on-ramp partner, they will capture your IP address and may conduct identity verification checks in order to meet obligations they have under sanctions and anti-money laundering laws. You should review the privacy notices and terms of service of those third parties.

# Brave News

Brave News is a private, ad-supported content news reader integrated into the Brave browser. It provides news content, Brave offers, display advertising, and promoted content. It is off by default.

When you turn ON Brave News, a range of content is presented by default. The default content is selected using Brave Search. You can at any time change the default content settings and choose what content you want appearing in your feed. You can also add feeds manually by subscribing directly to publishers' content using publicly available RSS feeds.

To protect your privacy, Brave employs a combination of methods for delivering content that ensure your browser cannot be identified or tracked by Brave or any third party. Headlines are made available on a public CDN in text files, the same file for all users for each region. Some images from publishers and images in the Brave News user interface are processed to improve performance and ensure they display correctly in the Brave News user experience. Processed images are all delivered through a private and encrypted proxy method. The proxy removes and does not retain IP addresses before passing the encrypted request to the private content server, which then sends the encrypted reply back to the browser via the proxy. All other publisher images are collected directly from the publishers from your device. When you add RSS feeds manually, the text and images are collected directly from the publisher of the RSS feed and included in Brave News on the client. The feed of text and images from Brave and from your RSS feeds is temporarily stored on your device, and it is replaced upon starting or refreshing your Brave News session.

Display advertising and promoted content is delivered to all browsers within a given country that have turned on and enabled Brave News. Images from these are served by Brave using its private and encrypted proxy. If you also enable Brave Ads, advertising will

be presented based on your interests, as inferred from your browsing behaviour and done on your device. Brave News remains private to you and anonymous.

Brave News will offer suggestions of sources you might like to follow. If you choose to follow a suggested source it will be added to your Following list; you can always unfollow a source via the Settings panel. The suggestions and your choices are determined on your browser and never leave your device. Your Brave News sessions are not logged or saved by Brave. This information is private to you and only you.

Brave's source list, content aggregator and Suggestions service are open source and available to view via GitHub.

**Please note**: The RSS feed content you add is collected directly from the feed source and not proxied by Brave. The Brave browser fetches it without ever hitting Brave servers, and Brave never knows anything about your chosen RSS feeds.

It's your choice. You can add, follow, unfollow, or hide content sources any time.

# Brave Talk

Brave Talk is a private video and/or audio conference tool. What you say or type in the service is not logged or saved. Who you talk to, when, and how, is private to you. See data processing details.

Please note that Brave uses the 8x8 communications platform, and software (API) capabilities of 8x8 (based on the Jitsi Open Source video conferencing software) to help deliver Brave Talk. 8x8 provides a service on behalf of Brave, and we remain responsible for Brave Talk.

Brave Talk is Internet-only; it does not support participation via telephony.

## What information does Brave Talk process?

We process the minimum information necessary to provide the Brave Talk service. This includes:

- Your IP address and the URL of the meeting that will be processed only to enable calls; they are not retained after a call ends.

- If you use the chat function, chats will be temporarily cached for the duration of the meeting; they are not retained after a call ends.
- If you record a meeting that you host, the recording will be temporarily stored on the server for 24 hours to allow you to download it. Your name and email address that you choose to display will be processed and available during the meeting.

While communications are encrypted between the Brave browser and Brave Talk servers via transport layer encryption, they are not encrypted on the server during a call, unless you enable Video Bridge Encryption (VBE). Additional security options are available to you in the settings menu once you initiate a call. These include:

- **Enable Lobby**: This lets you protect your meeting by only allowing people to enter after being approved by a moderator.
- **Add a passcode**: This lets you restrict access to the meeting to people who have been provided the code.
- **Enable Video Bridge Encryption (VBE)**: This is currently experimental. If you enable VBE, it will disable server side services such as recording and livestreaming. Note that if you enable VBE but other participants do not, they won't be able to see or hear you.

Please note that if you upgrade to the Brave Talk Premium plan, Brave will require an email address to initially create a premium account, and subsequently to manage your access to the account using anonymous credentials. We use the third-party payment provider Stripe to process payments for premium subscriptions. Stripe will process your email address, name, and payment card data for the purpose of managing your subscription payments only. Brave does not receive nor have access to your payment method details supplied to Stripe, and we cannot associate an account email address or payment details with your communications on Brave Talk.

**To avoid scams:** For the avoidance of phishing attacks, note that we at Brave will never contact Brave Browser users in a Brave Talk call.

We do not authenticate users or their associated avatar images. Accordingly, you should never share any confidential information with anyone on Brave Talk unless you are certain that you know who you are talking to. (Of course, this is a good practice regardless of whether you are using Brave Talk, or email, or any other form of communication.)

# Brave Translate

Brave removes IP addresses associated with requests submitted to the translation service. Additionally, any text submitted is not retained after the request completes. We do this to protect your privacy.

# Brave Firewall + VPN

You can subscribe to Brave Firewall + VPN in two ways: via account.brave.com, or via the applicable app store for your mobile device (iOS App Store or Google Play Store). Brave Firewall + VPN is powered by Guardian, and Guardian also provides technical support for Brave's Firewall + VPN service. To learn more about what information we use for subscriptions—and why—see our data processing details.

# Brave Leo

Brave Leo AI is our privacy-first AI-powered assistant integrated into the browser. Leo offers multiple capabilities including chat, webpage summaries, tab management, writing assistance, and more. Leo is free to use with limited access. If you sign up for Leo Premium, you will have access to more models, higher usage limits, and early access to new features.

When you use Leo, Brave shares with Leo's backend server the following information in order to complete your request:

- **For general chat queries**: your prompt and conversation context. In some cases, Leo will send queries derived from your input to Brave Search and use the search results to better answer your question.
- **For web page summaries and suggested questions**: the prompt and content of the page or pages you're viewing, including any text you have highlighted on the page.
- **For Tab Focus mode**: the titles and origins (not full URLs) of your open non-Private/non-Tor tabs.

- **Feedback**: If you submit feedback on Leo's responses, our servers will receive some information. See Brave Leo feedback for more details.
- **Privacy-preserving query analytics**: To better understand the types of queries Leo AI is used for, we use STAR and Nebula to learn aggregated insights without leaking individual behavior. In addition, we only extract non-identifying metadata, such as the broad category of a usery query, the language the query is written in, and the AI model used. For example, Brave may learn that a certain percentage of users engage Leo AI for creative writing, but not which users or even what they wrote.
- **Brave Leo Local Storage**: If you have enabled chat history, your conversations with Leo AI will be encrypted and stored locally on your device. We do not save these conversations, nor do we use conversations for model training. You can disable conversation storage or clear saved chats by going to **brave://settings/leo-ai**. If you clear your browsing history, any associated page content in your chats will also be removed. Chat history is not available in Private Windows or Private Windows with Tor.

See data processing details.

## Brave Leo Privacy Protections

Brave Leo includes multiple privacy protections:

- We do not collect identifiers that can be linked to you (such as IP address).
- We don't store or retain prompts, responses, context, or personal data on our servers. We may cache large prompts to improve performance but these are deleted within minutes. We do not use your conversations for model training.
- Conversation history is stored locally on your device.
- Users do not need to create a Brave Premium account to use the free version of Leo.
- If you sign up for Leo Premium, you're issued unlinkable tokens that validate your subscription when using Premium services. Brave has no way of connecting your purchase details with your usage of Leo Premium.

# Web Discovery Project

The Web Discovery Project is intended to make Brave Search more relevant and useful for everyone. If you opt in, you'll contribute some anonymous data about searches and web

page visits made within the Brave Browser (including pages arrived at via some, but not all, other search engines). This data helps build the Brave Search independent index, and ensure we show relevant results to your search queries and support more relevant experiences with Brave products and services.

Collection is done in a privacy-preserving fashion. The Web Discovery Project records the terms you search for on some search engines if that search query passes a series of checks, intended to avoid recording or sending sensitive queries. For example, WDP will not send search queries that are very long, including email addresses or long numbers.

WDP also records some of the pages you visit, if the URLs pass a series of checks designed to filter out unique or identifying URLs. For example, URLs that are too long or include certain terms or long numbers are never sent. Additionally, WDP protects the URLs you send by encrypting them in a manner that prevents Brave from seeing or reading the URL unless it has been sent by a large number of other users.

The system is designed so that no data received can be linked back to individuals or their devices. For a URL to be sent it needs to be visited independently by a large number of people. All data received is unlinkable, making it impossible to build profiles or sessions of Web Discovery Project contributors.

Read a full description of the Web Discovery Project methodology.

# How we improve Brave

## Diagnostic reports

When Brave crashes or freezes, it creates a report that can be sent to us to help us diagnose and fix whatever caused the problem. This report contains technical information about your computer system and the event causing the problem. The data can't be used to identify you.

We use a service called Backtrace.io to store the reports. You can choose whether to send us these reports. Even if you have chosen to send reports in the past, you can turn off future reports in settings.

## Privacy Preserving Product Analytics

The Browser sends us anonymous reports to alert us to product problems and necessary improvements. None of the information it reports harms your privacy. The report only describes general use of the Browser or other Brave products, such as a general range of how many extensions are installed, a general range of how many tabs are open, and whether features like Shields, Rewards, and Ads are switched on. See the full list of questions here. These reports are stripped of metadata, and aggregated with measurements reported by many other instances of Brave. The data are not personal, and cannot be combined to identify you. You can deactivate Privacy-Preserving Product Analytics in Settings.

## Your feedback

We collect feedback solely for the purpose of improving our products and services, enhancing your browsing experience, and resolving compatibility issues. Any personally identifiable information (PII) you provide, such as your contact details, will be handled with strict confidentiality. We do not sell, trade, or transfer your information to any third parties. See data processing details.

### Web compatibility reports

If you submit a Web compatibility report, you'll have the option to include certain details to help us analyze and address compatibility issues. Providing this information is voluntary, and any data you submit will be deleted from Brave's servers after 30 days. See our Web compatibility reports wiki page for more details on what data is collected.

### Brave Leo feedback

You can voluntarily submit feedback on Leo's responses (Brave's privacy-first, AI-powered assistant) by clicking the thumbs-up or thumbs-down icons. This sends the rating, full text of the current conversation, language, selected AI model, version, and Premium subscription status (if any). You also have the option to include additional details and the current website to assist us in improving Leo's responses. All submitted data will be deleted from Brave's servers after 1 year.

## Nightly, Dev, and Beta browser versions

Nightly, Dev, and Beta versions of the Brave Browser are experimental previews of new Brave Browser versions. They allow us to test new features so that we can find and fix errors before releasing a new version of the Brave Browser. These test versions of the Browser may automatically send crash reports to Brave so that we can identify and fix problems. A crash report can contain personal information. See data processing details.

**How to switch this feature off.** You can switch off "Automatically send usage statistics and crash reports to Brave Software" in settings.

> **Tip:** you can quickly access settings by copying ***brave://settings*** into your address bar.

These incomplete versions of Brave represent unfinished and untested work on future versions of Brave, and their incomplete behaviour may not be adequately described by this policy. More information about the safety & reliability of pre-release versions of Brave can be found in our development documentation.

## Location

## Brave Rewards

## Brave News

## Brave Talk

## Brave Firewall + VPN

## Brave Leo

## Brave IPFS Public Gateway

### Your feedback

### Browser testing and research (Nightly, Dev, and Beta versions only)

## Help with privacy settings in Brave

You can find guides on how to change privacy settings in Brave in the Help Center.

## Contacting Brave about your personal data and privacy rights

To contact our data protection officer and privacy team with privacy related enquiries, or to exercise your data protection and privacy rights, email privacy@brave.com.

It's Brave's policy to not collect personal data[1] unless it's necessary to provide services to our users, or to meet certain legal obligations. We do not buy or sell personal data about consumers.

Where we process personal data about you (subject to laws such as the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), or California privacy laws such as the CCPA or CPRA), you have the following rights:

- **Right to be informed**: You have the right to know what personal data we process about you and why, together with information about your rights. We explain this via our product privacy policies and/or contextual privacy notices.
- **Right of access**: Where we process personal data about you, you have the right to request a copy of it.
- **Right to delete**: When certain grounds apply, you can ask us to delete personal data we are processing about you. Please note, we have a separate global policy for Brave Search results and the right to be forgotten.
- **Right to rectification**: You can ask us to correct inaccurate personal data and/or to update incomplete data.

- **Right to restriction**: In certain circumstances, you can request that we refrain from processing your personal data.
- **Right to object**: In certain circumstances, you can object to the processing of your personal data (for example to object to the use of your data for profiling and/or purely automated decision making). Please note that we do not buy or sell personal data about consumers.
- **Right to data portability**: In certain circumstances you have the right to request and receive personal data in a structured, commonly used, machine readable format that makes it possible to reuse the data. Please note, anonymous data is not subject to this right.
- **Right to lodge a complaint with a regulatory authority**: Brave is based in the USA. The authority to lodge a complaint about Brave will depend on where you live. If you're in the EU you can contact our nominated representative under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), or you can complain to the Irish Data Protection Commissioner. If you're in the UK you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office. If you're in California you can complain to the California Privacy Protection Agency.

For EU residents, we have appointed a nominated representative under the GDPR to act on our behalf regarding GDPR compliance. You may contact our nominated representative if you wish; however, the representative will refer enquiries to Brave's data protection officer for consideration.

Our EU nominated representative is:

Brave EU Nominated Representative
Care of Castlebridge
New Work Junction
Clonard, Wexford
Ireland

brave@gdprnomrep.eu

We'll update this policy whenever we make material changes to our practices, and we'll announce it to let you know. We hope you'll find any changes agreeable, but if you're not comfortable with changes to the info we collect or how we use it, we understand your choice to stop using Brave.

## Footnotes

1 Personal data means any information that relates to an identified or identifiable living individual. In the USA, this is often referred to as Personal Information (PI) or Personally Identifiable Information (PII). These terms are equivalent but not identical.

This can include information that can directly identify an individual—such as name or email address—and any other information that may make a person indirectly identifiable—such as online identifiers that could be combined with other data to identify an individual, or used on their own to single out individuals and distinguish one person from another with an intent to learn something about them or to take an action towards them. ↩ ↩

Website & email

Publishers & creators

Advertisers

CCPA

About

Blog

Brand assets

Careers

Events

GitHub

Research

Reviews

Tor Onion address

Brave Creators

**Advertise**

Browser Ads

Search Ads

Ads Dashboard

**Offices**

Brave San Francisco

580 Howard St. Unit 402,
San Francisco, CA 94105

Choose a language

English

**Contact**

Support

community.brave.app

user-support@brave.com

Advertising

adsales@brave.com

Business

bizdev@brave.com

Press

press@brave.com

**Developer resources**

Brave Wallet docs

Brave Search API docs

MCP Server

brave

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